

Manibaug Paralaya Youth Press Corps (MPYPC) Governing Charter

Article I: Name and Nature

Section 1. The organization shall be known as the Manibaug Paralaya Youth Press Corps (MPYPC).

Section 2. MPYPC is a youth-led, independent media entity recognized by the Barangay of Manibaug Paralaya, operating under Republic Act No. 8044 (Youth in Nation-Building Act) and other applicable Philippine youth organization laws.

Article II: Mission and Vision

Section 1. Mission: To uphold journalistic integrity, promote civic awareness, and serve the public through factual, ethical, and youth-centered journalism, adhering to the Philippine Press Institute's Code of Ethics.

Section 2. Vision: A community empowered through informed youth leadership and truthful reporting.

Article III: Editorial Independence

Section 1. MPYPC retains absolute editorial control over its content, direction, and internal affairs, free from political, commercial, or governmental interference.

Section 2. Editorial autonomy violation is defined as any action, including censorship, coerced editorial alignment, or unauthorized interference in leadership appointments, that undermines MPYPC's independent control over content, staffing, or governance.

Section 3. Attempts to interfere by any official, entity, or individual shall be publicly disclosed and may constitute grounds for severance of Barangay recognition, as per Article IX.

Article IV: Organizational Structure

Section 1. Barangay Press Adviser: The founder of MPYPC, serving as guardian of its charter, integrity, and mission. The Adviser may appoint or remove the Editor-in-Chief (EIC) via signed decree and override or veto decisions in cases of legal, ethical, or structural violations, or to ensure organizational continuity. These powers are subject to the Suspensus Potestas Procedure (Article V).

Section 2. Editor-in-Chief (EIC): Appointed by the Press Adviser, the EIC has full authority over content creation, publication, staff appointments, and budgeting, subject to the charter and ethical standards.

Section 3. Associate Editor-in-Chief: Appointed by the EIC, assists the EIC, oversees the Copy Desk (enforcing AP Style), reviews pitch submissions via Google Forms, and succeeds the EIC if vacated.

Section 4. Department Heads: Appointed by the EIC, oversee specific beats:

- a. News Editor: Manages breaking news and event coverage.
- b. Opinion Editor: Oversees editorials and letters to the editor.
- c. Sports Editor: Handles athlete profiles and game reports.
- d. Features Editor: Manages human-interest stories.

- e. Investigative Editor: Conducts FOIA requests and exposés.
- f. Photo Editor: Manages assignment photography.
- g. Multimedia Director: Oversees video reports and podcasts.

Section 5. Editorial Board: Comprises the EIC, Associate EIC, Department Heads, and three Ethics Committee members elected by MPYPC members. Added responsibility for all governance (amendments, Adviser removal, severance).

Section 6. No Barangay officials or appointees may hold positions or voting rights.

Article V: Suspensus Potestas Procedure

Section 1. In the event of a significant action by the Barangay Press Adviser (e.g., removal of the EIC or veto of editorial decisions), the EIC may activate Suspensus Potestas via a public proclamation published in MPYPC's official channels, stating the basis for the challenge. This temporarily nullifies the Adviser's powers for five (5) days.

Section 2. During this period, the EIC shall convene the Editorial Board to determine if the Adviser's action is rational and aligned with this charter, the Philippine Press Institute's Code of Ethics, and MPYPC's objectives.

Section 3. A majority vote among the Editorial Board is required to override the Adviser's action.

Section 4. If no decision is reached within five (5) days, the Adviser's powers are restored, and the action proceeds. The EIC may request a one-time two (2)-day extension with majority approval.

Section 5. The EIC may call for the removal of the Barangay Press Adviser, requiring a two-thirds (2/3) supermajority of the Editorial Board.

Section 6. If the Adviser's action is upheld, the EIC may request non-binding mediation from a neutral external body (e.g., municipal youth council or journalism ethics board).

Article VI: Membership

Section 1. Membership is open to youth residents of Manibaug Paralaya aged 13–21, subject to application and approval by the EIC.

Section 2. Members may participate in editorial meetings, pitch content, and vote in elections for Editorial Board positions.

Article VII: Funding and Finances

Section 1. MPYPC may receive an annual unconditional civic grant from the Barangay Council, with a minimum of PHP 30,000, subject to a transparent application process per Barangay guidelines. Withholding of funds requires written justification within ten (10) days; failure to justify may trigger public disclosure.

Section 2. MPYPC may seek alternative funding, including municipal youth grants, NGO support, sponsored content (clearly labeled), and community crowdfunding (e.g., Press Freedom Patreon), ensuring no editorial influence.

Section 3. Financial transparency reports shall be published quarterly, detailing income, expenses, and funding sources.

Section 4. An independent bank account shall be maintained with two signatories: the EIC and a Treasurer appointed by the EIC.

Article VIII: Ethics and Oversight

Section 1. MPYPC shall adhere to the Philippine Press Institute's Code of Ethics, supplemented by an MPYPC Ethics Manual adapted from PPI standards.

Section 2. An Ethics Committee, comprising three Editorial Board members elected by the members of MPYPC, shall review controversial content or alleged ethical violations, reporting findings to the EIC.

Section 3. Editorial meetings shall be held weekly, chaired by the EIC, to review pitches and ensure compliance with AP Style via the Copy Desk.

Article IX: Severance of Recognition

Section 1. MPYPC may terminate its formal Barangay recognition if its editorial autonomy is violated, as defined in Article III, Section 2, by a two-thirds (2/3) majority vote of the Editorial Board.

Section 2. Prior to termination, MPYPC shall initiate dispute resolution with the Barangay Council, involving written complaints, mediation within ten (10) days, and arbitration if unresolved within thirty (30) days, as outlined in the Barangay Resolution (Section 8).

Section 3. Upon termination, MPYPC shall receive a final funding installment of PHP 30,000 from the Barangay to support transition, as per the Barangay Resolution.

Section 4. MPYPC shall continue as an independent civic entity under Republic Act No. 8044 and other youth organization laws.

Article X: Dispute Resolution

Section 1. Internal disputes (e.g., ethics violations, staff conflicts) shall be addressed by the EIC, with appeals to the Ethics Committee or Editorial Board.

Section 2. External disputes with the Barangay Council (e.g., autonomy violations, funding issues) shall follow the dispute resolution process outlined in the Barangay Resolution (Section 8).

Article XI: Amendments

Section 1. Amendments to this charter may be proposed by the EIC or a majority of the Editorial Board and must be approved by a two-thirds (2/3) majority of the Editorial Board.

Section 2. Proposed amendments shall be published to members at least seven (7) days before voting.

Adopted this ____ day of _____, 2025, in Manibaug Paralaya, Porac, Pampanga.

Signed: **Rav Johruh Kashmiel L. Tuazon**
Barangay Press Adviser and Founder

[NAME]
Editor-in-Chief